the killing of Osama bin Laden in Abbottabad and the attack of NATO forces on the Salala checkpost. However, the sentiments against the terrorists belonging to TTP and Al Qaeda did not show any sign of a let-up. On the contrary, the people became weary of terrorism with every passing month and year.

Eventually, some opposition leaders like Imran Khan of PTI showed sympathy for the Waziristan-based terrorists in 2011 and 2012. They talked about negotiations and end to war, which was not Pakistan's war but America's war. In fact, this stance and approach influenced many people. The confusing statements of the Interior Minister of Pakistan and Punjab law minister of seeing Indian and foreign influences in every terrorist attack instead of directly accusing TTP caused great confusion among the public to identify the real culprit. Obviously, such rhetoric divided public sentiments and provided a lifeline to the terrorists. It hindered the security forces to fight the terrorists in North Waziristan and elsewhere.

Compared to urbanites, the people of suburban and rural areas were less concerned about terrorism mainly because terrorists targeted major urban centres and terrorist activities hardly took place in villages or small towns. Usman Pannu, president of Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP), Ferozewala, Punjab, said, 'People of villages are more concerned about price hike in diesel rather than terrorism. Increase in price of diesel affects them badly because their tube wells and tractors are run by it.'[11]

Pakistan's resilience to survive despite acute terrorism is much due to its large rural population, which had remained safe from terrorist activities. However, they could not escape from radicalisation and sectarianism.